

» ENGLAND TOUR
CHALLENGES AHEAD



Gill's reign: Shubman Gill takes charge as India's new Test captain after Rohit Sharma's retirement, with a daunting first task — leading a transitional squad in a five-match series in England, starting June 20. K. R. DEEPAK

THE HARD RESET



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India begins its **new WTC cycle** not with stability, but a clean slate. Five Tests in England — with a young squad and no recent series win there — could shape how far it gets this time.

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India begins its toughest Test transition in years with a five-match tour of England. With Virat Kohli, Rohit Sharma, and R. Ashwin moving on, a new World Test Championship cycle kicks off under Shubman Gill — a young captain leading an even younger squad into one of the most unforgiving environments in world cricket.

The challenge is clear. India hasn't

won a Test series in England since 2007. And this time, the team must make do without any of its senior batting pillars.

Light on experience

Only Rishabh Pant and K.L. Rahul bring substantial experience in English conditions. Captain Gill has played three Tests in England (two WTC finals and the rescheduled Birmingham Test), scoring just 88 runs at an average of 14.66. For

others like Yashasvi Jaiswal, Karun Nair, and Sai Sudharsan, this will be a first taste of Test cricket in England.

Nair and Sudharsan arrive with strong domestic numbers. But Test cricket in England demands more than form — it demands adaptability.

Sudharsan earned the Orange Cap in the IPL this season, and his experience of playing county cricket for Surrey will certainly help him assess the English conditions better.